

APPS

	Router	OS					Extensions					
		Windows	Mac OS	Linux	Android	iOS	Chrome	Edge	Firefox	Brave	Opera	Vivaldi
CyberGhost	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	No
ExpressVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
IPVanish	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No
NordVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	No
Private Internet Access	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	No
PrivateVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No	No
PureVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	No
StrongVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No
Surfshark	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
VyprVPN	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	No

CyberGhost

SCORE: 6.73
RANK: 4

CyberGhost VPN is based in Romania, which is not one of the Eyes countries, which means that government agencies cannot force CyberGhost to hand over its users' data. Cyberghost was one of the earliest services in the industry to publish a transparency report back in 2011, revealing to its users all the requests for information from government organisations. CyberGhost does anonymously track user logins, and a single account can only use the service from one country. Although CyberGhost claims that it does not log user information, it does track the users more than is necessary, that is the email address and payment information. CyberGhost VPN is the only shortlisted service that provides a trial, one that does not require any payment information to be provided. Do note that the trial lasts only for twenty four hours since the time of activation, and that it is a throttled connection that does not

provide the speeds for a paid service. As such, the trial does not provide users with a realistic idea of the service. Note that the service is capped at 1 Gbps, and if you have a faster connection then it does not make much sense to use CyberGhost. In our speedtests, CyberGhost consistently performed worse than other competing services in terms of raw speed, but we were able to stream without any problems. For purposes of torrenting though, forget about CyberGhost as the speeds there are abysmally low. CyberGhost has apps for all the major platforms, so there is no problem there. When it comes to RAM usage, CyberGhost falls somewhere in the middle, not using too much RAM as the most resource hungry VPNs, but not being a lightweight app either. Where CyberGhost really shines is the department of security, as it is one of the few services to offer both a warrant canary and a transparency report. CyberGhost has a kill switch, supports split tunneling, and users can get a dedicated IP address if they require it. Note that the

kill switch is always active, and there is no way to disable it, so that if you are engaging in some non critical online activity, such as playing a game, and the VPN service goes down, then you will lose the connection to the game servers even though the internet is still up. This can be an irritating thing if you have forgotten that the VPN is turned on, say while downloading a legal torrent. CyberGhost allows you to anonymously purchase a

private IP token on the service, which you have to then redeem in the app. Note that there is no way to recover this token number if it is lost, and a helpdesk request to CyberGhost cannot solve this particular problem. One of the great things about CyberGhost is that it has identified ideal servers for torrenting, gaming and streaming, and serves these to the users.

Private Internet Access

SCORE: 5.86
RANK: 3

Boasting of 35,000 servers in 70 countries, Private Internet Access has the largest network among all the services that we tested. The large number of servers here makes a big difference in the user experience as the users are spoiled for choice when it comes to picking a server, so there are plenty of alternatives available if a particular server is not performing up to expectations. The latencies to the servers are displayed in each country in realtime, making it easy to pick a choice, and this goes a long way in ensuring high speeds. When it came to speedtests, Private Internet Access came in second from the top after ExpressVPN, but did not perform that well when it came to downloading torrents. There are no bandwidth caps, and it generously supports 10 simultaneous connections at a time, which should be ample for families. Apart from a killswitch there is an advanced killswitch that blocks traffic from outside the app even if the VPN is

